

Practice Paper 4

Crime, loyalty and conscience; appearance and reality · Three hours · 100 marks

PAPER I · 40 MARKS

Answer **all** the questions in Section A. Select **either** I, II **or** III from Section B and answer all the questions given below it.

Paper I · Section A: Poetry, Prose and Drama 30 marks

Read the following extracts and answer all the questions given below them.

I POETRY

I (i) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"Smile on our loves, and while thou drawest the
Blue curtains of the sky, scatter thy silver dew
On every flower that shuts its sweet eyes
In timely sleep."

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet. 1 mark

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.....

(b) Who is addressed as 'thou'? 1 mark

.....
.....

(c) What are the 'Blue curtains of the sky'? 1 mark

.....
.....

(d) What mood is created in these lines? How? 2 marks

.....
.....
.....

I (ii) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"The king was silent. Then he said slowly,
'Never since I was born of my mother
Have I seen or heard of a skull which spoke.'"

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

(b) Who told the king about the skull?

1 mark

(c) What does the king's silence suggest?

1 mark

(d) What happens as a result of this conversation?

2 marks

II PROSE

II (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"What a silly thing Love is," said the Student as he walked away. "It is not half as useful as Logic, for it does not prove anything."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) When does the Student say this?

1 mark

(c) Name one feeling of the Student at this moment.

1 mark

(d) What is ironic about these words?

2 marks

II (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Oh my God, the sea's coming in."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) Who says these words?

1 mark

(c) How does the narrator react at first?

1 mark

(d) Why is this line important in the extract?

2 marks

III DRAMA

III (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"After all I had asked you.....After all you had promised faithfully.....Why—why did you look in at me?"

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who is the speaker?

1 mark

(c) What promise has been broken?

1 mark

(d) How will this incident affect the relationship between the speaker and the person spoken to?

2 marks

III (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Fire, then! You can't understand what happiness it would be to die before those beautiful eyes, to be shot by a revolver held in that little, velvet hand..."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who speaks these words, and to whom?

1 mark

(c) Why has the speaker been told he will be shot?

1 mark

(d) What change in the speaker do these words show?

2 marks

Paper I • Section B: Novels 10 marks

Select **EITHER** I, II **OR** III and answer all the questions given below it.

I • THE PRINCE AND THE PAUPER

Read the following extract from *The Prince and the Pauper* by Mark Twain and answer all the questions given below it.

"But meantime, Miles Hendon was resolving the difficulty. "Let the child go," said he; "ye heartless dogs, do ye not see how young and frail he is? Let him go—I will take his lashes."

"Marry, a good thought—and thanks for it," said Sir Hugh, his face lighting with a sardonic satisfaction. "Let the little beggar go, and give this fellow a dozen in his place—an honest dozen, well laid on."

...

Hendon made no outcry under the scourge, but bore the heavy blows with soldierly fortitude. This, together with his redeeming the boy by taking his stripes for him, compelled the respect of even that forlorn and degraded mob that was gathered there; and its gibes and hootings died away, and no sound remained but the sound of the falling blows."

(i) When and where does this incident take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does Sir Hugh accept Hendon's offer so readily?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) soldierly fortitude 1 mark

(b) its gibes and hootings died away

1 mark

(iv) What does this incident reveal about Hendon and Hugh? How does Edward reward Hendon?

4 marks

II · BRINGING TONY HOME

Many years later, the narrator, now an adult, returns to the place of his childhood. He sees a man coming up from the hollow below the road and thinks he recognises him:

"he came walking with a swagger like the way toughs move and his manner changed immediately when he saw me standing by the car"

(i) What is the situation described here?

2 marks

(ii) Why does the man's manner change?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) walking with a swagger

1 mark

(b) the way toughs move

1 mark

(iv) What does this meeting show about the changes time has brought?

4 marks

III • THE VENDOR OF SWEETS

Mali and Grace keep pressing Jagan to invest money in the story-writing machine. Jagan decides how he will respond:

"Gandhi has taught me peaceful methods, and that's how I'm going to meet their demand."

(i) When does this take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does Jagan distrust the scheme?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) peaceful methods

1 mark

(b) meet their demand

1 mark

(iv) How does Jagan apply "peaceful methods"? Is this an honest use of Gandhi's teaching?

4 marks

Paper II · Essays 60 marks

PAPER II · 60 MARKS

Answer **four** questions, selecting **one** each from the four sections: Poetry, Drama, Prose and Fiction.

HOW PAPER II ESSAYS ARE MARKED (15 MARKS EACH)

Content 7 · Organisation 4 · Language 4. Examiners reward relevant points from the text, apt quotations, a clear argument that answers the question, and your own sensible response. The points below are a guide, not a fixed list.

POETRY (Answer one question only)

1. How does Tennyson make the reader see the world from the eagle's point of view in 'The Eagle'? 15 marks

2. "In 'Farewell to Barn and Stack and Tree' Housman makes us pity a murderer." Discuss. 15 marks

3. How does Yasmine Gooneratne use the language of news and sport in 'Big Match 1983'? 15 marks

4. "In 'The Clown's Wife', the wife shows more strength than her husband." Do you agree? 15 marks

5. "We should admire Upside-Down rather than laugh at him." Discuss with reference to 'Upside Down'. 15 marks

DRAMA (Answer one question only)

6. "Yohyo is a victim, not a villain." Discuss with reference to 'Twilight of a Crane'. 15 marks

7. "'The Bear' makes fun of romantic ideas about love." Discuss. 15 marks

PROSE (Answer one question only)

8. How does the fact that 'Wave' is a memoir make the tragedy more moving?

15 marks

9. "In 'The Lumber Room' the child is wiser than the adults." Discuss.

15 marks

10. What message about sport and its values does Sangakkara give in 'The Lahore Attack'?

15 marks

11. What does the red rose symbolise in 'The Nightingale and the Rose'?

15 marks

FICTION (Answer one question only)

12. How does Mark Twain create humour in 'The Prince and the Pauper'?

15 marks

13. How are the narrator's parents presented in 'Bringing Tony Home'?

15 marks

14. What is the role of the cousin in 'The Vendor of Sweets'?

15 marks

These are original LitHelp practice questions written to the format of the G.C.E. (O/L) 2023(2024) and 2024(2025) papers and the Ministry of Education's 2025(2026) model papers. They are not official past-paper questions. For copyrighted set texts, only short lines are quoted and the situation is described in our own words.